

but what with the current penchant for individual cakes on individual stands, their 10-inch rounds are perfect. I had three (with a dessert table . . . see below) and they were great.

24. Decorate the cake with flowers

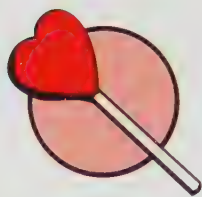
Why pay extra cash for frosting flowers on the cake when you could have real ones, often at a fraction of the price? If your florist wants to charge an arm and a leg for cake flowers, get them to drop off some extra petals and have an artistic friend arrange these on the cake. It's classy and tasteful, and your guests won't have to deal with mouthfuls of that awful frosting (unless, of course, you like frosting . . .).

25. Have a dessert table vs. cake alone

Originally, I wanted brownies alone. I ended up with brownies, mints, and cake, and it was perfect. And cheaper, because we bought the brownie mix and my mom made them. It wasn't too much work for her, and the overall effect at the wedding was more fun than that of cake alone.

26. Make your own cake stand

I used two hurricanes (of different sizes) and a small candle holder (upside



down). Classy, cheap, and fun. Just like me.

27. Make all your cakes the same flavor

The more cake flavors you have, the more you'll pay. Instead, pick your favorite and serve that. Bonus? No siblings arguing over who gets the chocolate!

28. Pass on the fondant

It's expensive *and* it tastes nasty. It looks nice, but not as nice as you would expect it to, for the cost. Other frostings look almost as nice, taste hundreds of times better, and cost much, much less.

29. Cut the round cake, but serve the sheet cake

We didn't do this, because of the brownies, but it's a tried-and-true way to save money. Put a smallish, decorated, round cake on the stand to cut. After you smear each other with frosting, have someone disappear